

Loop tab to see your looping options. You can also use the old trustworthy way of copy-paste to get a track to loop as long as you want it to.

Editing A Wave Form

 If you know your music theory inside out, you can directly edit a wave form. This means that you will actually change the wave form manually, by using your mouse. Do not do this unless you know what you are doing, or are just playing around with a track you don't really need anyway.

Changing a wave form is especially useful to professionals when a particular wave peak clips—there is no peak to the wave, instead it looks like a plateau. In such cases, you can adjust the wave form to a more suitable peak, rather than a plateau.

Sound Forge

In Sound Forge, you need to use the pencil tool to modify a wave. This tool button is



shaped like a pencil, and placed right below the Help menu. Click on it to enable the pencil cursor, then zoom in to your wave to see the frame points. Now you can use your pencil tool to just drag the points higher or

lower, redrawing your wave as you go along.

Audition

In Audition, there is no specific tool required to redraw a wave. All you need to do is zoom in to see the frame points and then drag them using the mouse. This will let you restructure your wave any way you see fit.

Mixing

 Perhaps the most important aspect of audio editing is mixing. Whether you are creating your own tracks, or using readymade ones, chances are, sooner or later you are going to need to mix them in order to get the sounds you require.

Bonus Tip

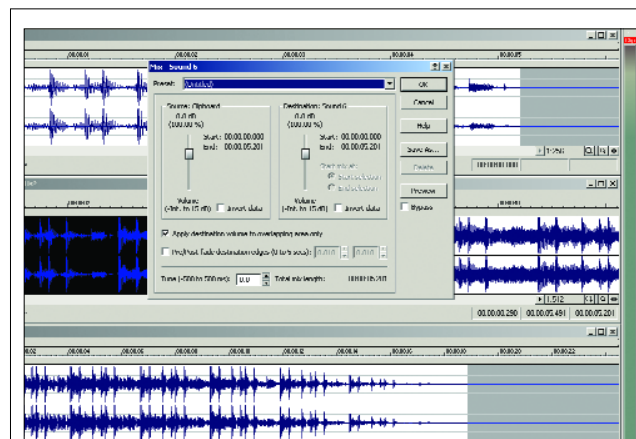
Overdoing it

You don't need to add a million effects to make a track or loop sound great. In the end, this is all about good music, and you will often come across tracks that need no improvement whatsoever. Don't change things for the sake of change!

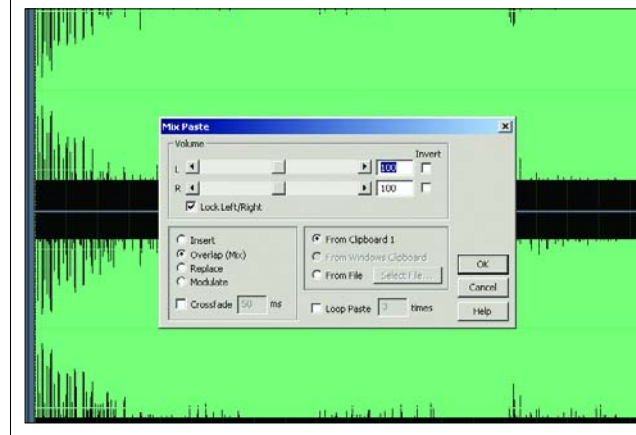
Sound Forge

In Sound Forge, you need to decide which two selections or tracks you wish to mix, and carefully check their beats and speeds. Even if you are mixing one part of a song with another part of the same song, beware, tempos vary. Just because it's the same song doesn't mean you can just copy paste one beat and place it over another—unless it's a fixed electronica beat, as used in some trance and disco tracks.

To mix two tracks, open a new file, and then copy a track and paste it in the new file. Now, copy the second track or selection from the exact spot you want the mixing to occur. Go to the new file and select the exact spot in the first file from where you want mixing to occur. Once your cursor is at the correct spot, right-click and select "Mix...". A box will pop up and ask you to specify a few settings, such as the volume



When mixing, be particular about cursor placement, and don't forget to set the volumes appropriately



Expert Opinion



Gilroy Valladares
Operations Manager
Sound Dot Com

To help us demystify most of the basics, we got Gilroy Valladares to share some of the tricks he uses to edit audio. Gilroy is operations manager at

Sound Dot Com, a professional Live Sound and Touring company that provides audio expertise for events all over the world.

Their portfolio includes the Sahara Sangeet Awards held recently at the Royal Albert Hall, London, the Gladrags Megamodel show, the CEAT Cricket Awards, War of the DJs, as well as providing expertise for live performances by bands such as Deep Purple and UB40.

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